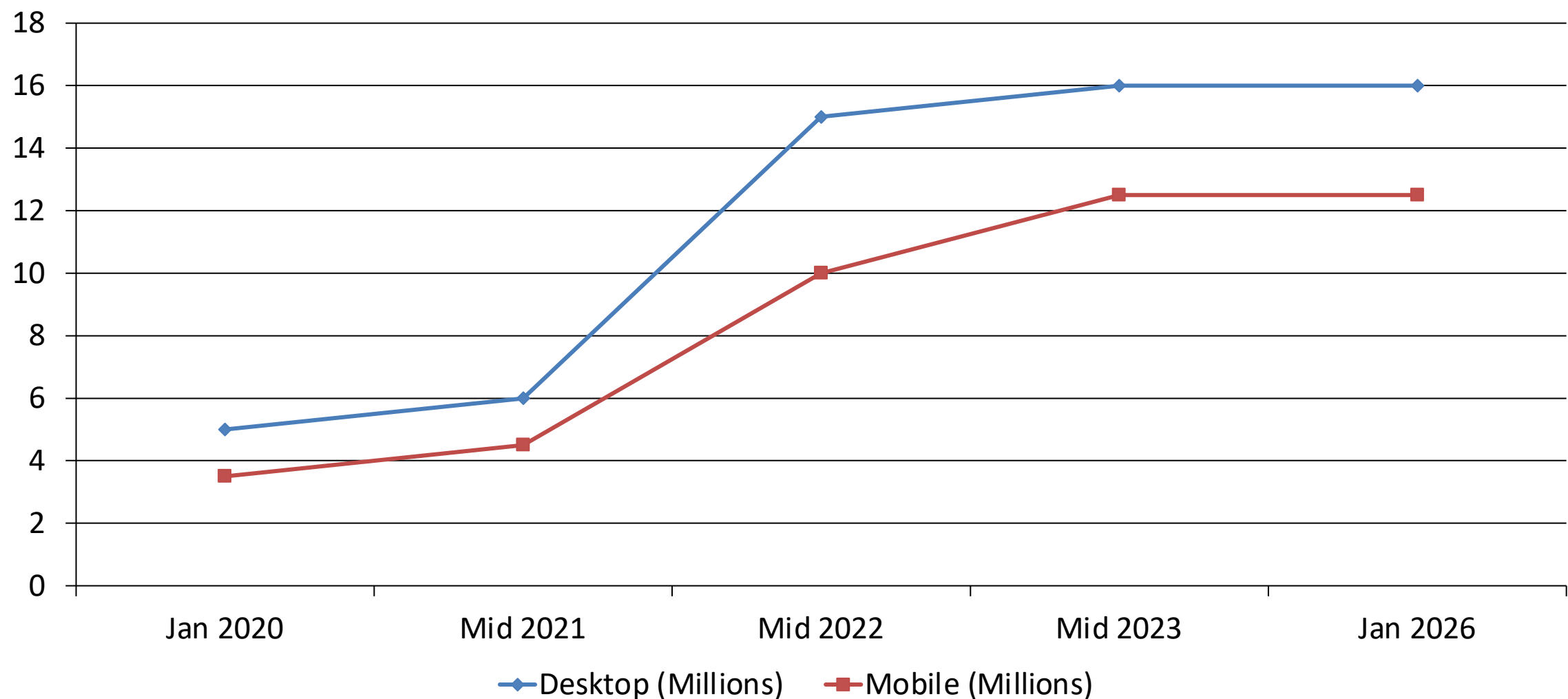


State of the Web 2020–2025: Tracking Page Weight, Protocols & Security at Scale

Data Source: HTTP Archive

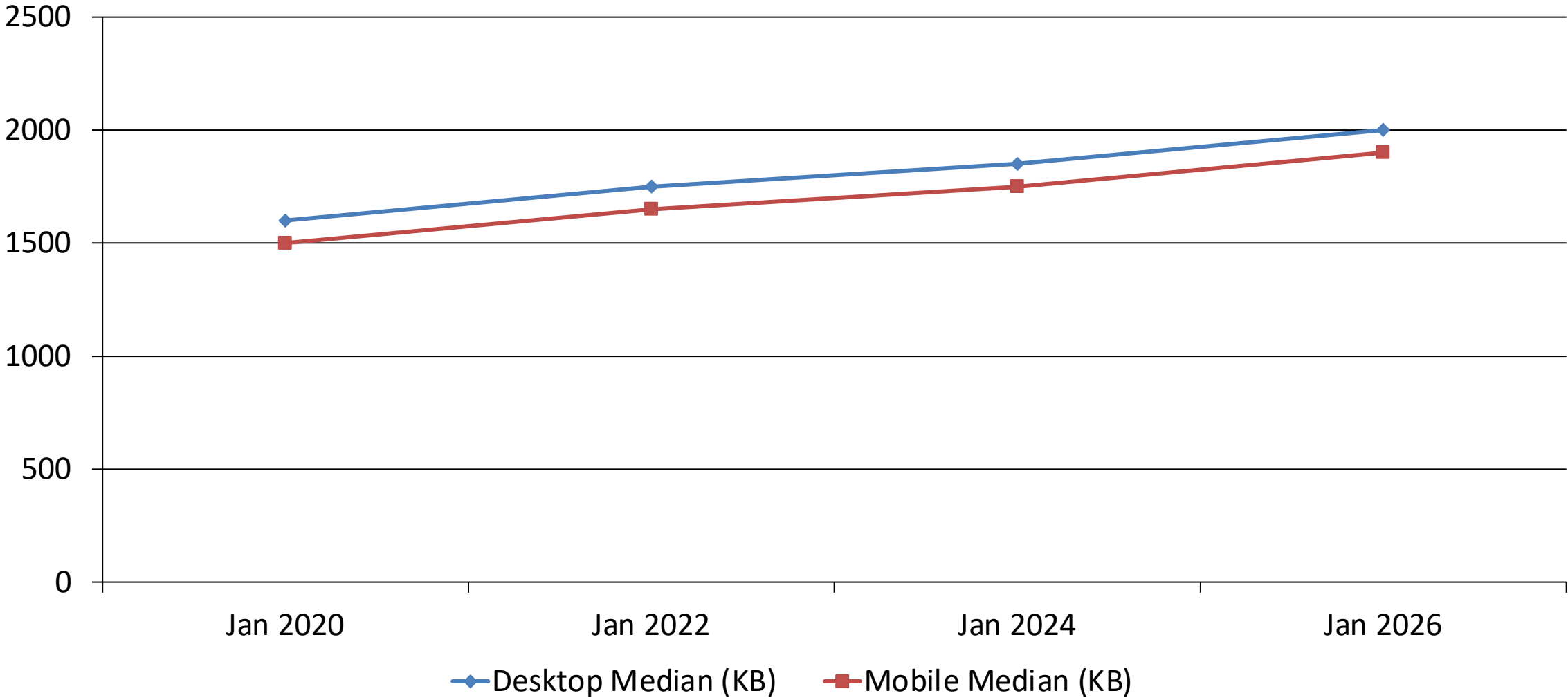
Time Range: January 2020 – March 2026

Crawl Sample Size Tripled: From ~5M to 16M Desktop URLs Since 2020



Sharp jump around mid-2022 stabilizing near 16M (Desktop) and 12.5M (Mobile).

Median Page Weight Climbs Steadily to ~2,000 KB on Desktop



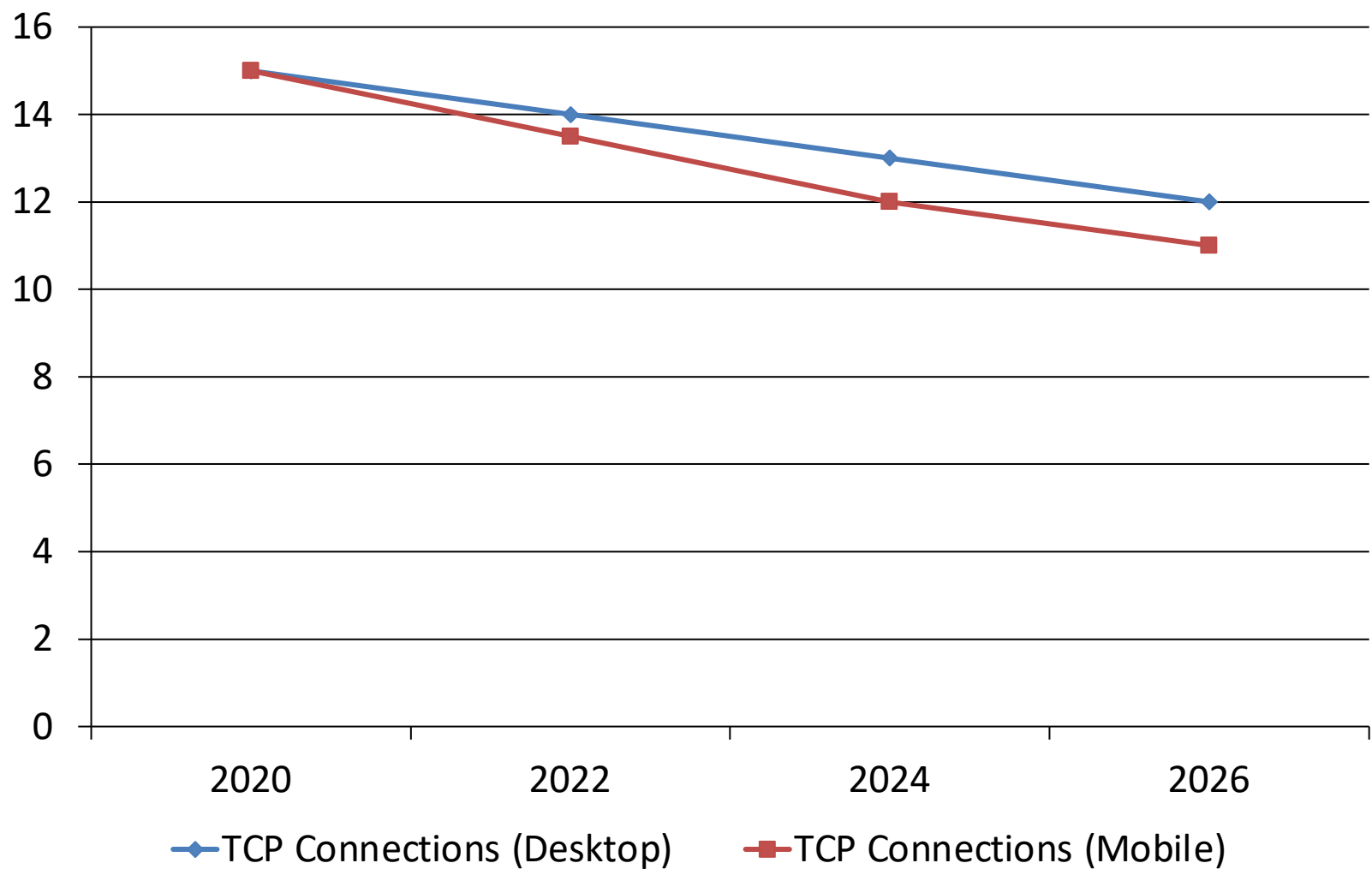
Note: The 75th-percentile desktop page exceeds 4,000 KB, indicating a long tail of heavy pages.

76 Requests per Desktop Page While TCP Connections Drop to 12

Total Requests (Median)

Desktop: 76 (▲ 2.7%)

Mobile: 71 (▲ 2.9%)



Efficiency gains from multiplexing (HTTP/2 & HTTP/3)

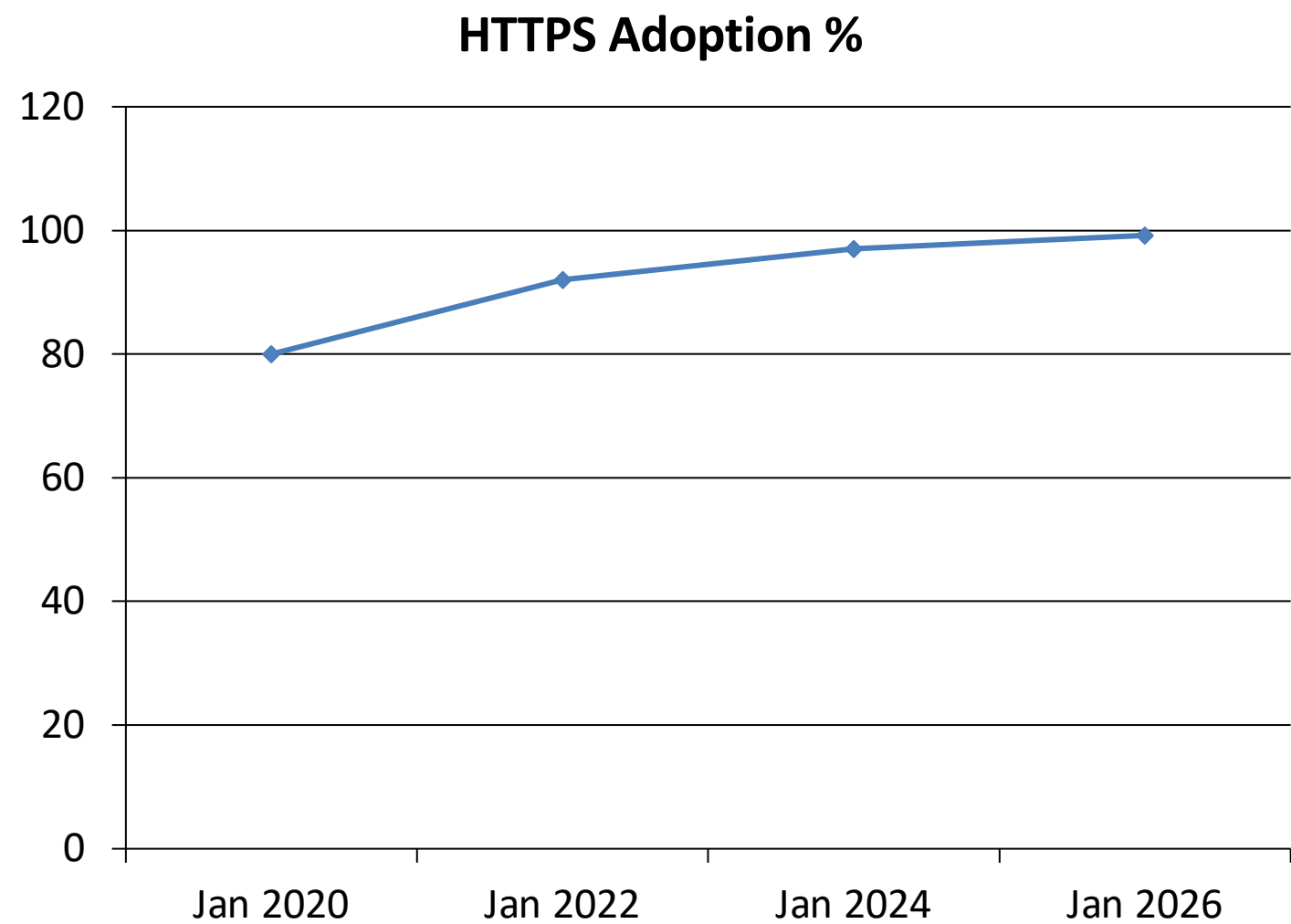
HTTPS Requests Reach 99%: Encryption Is Now the Default

99.2%

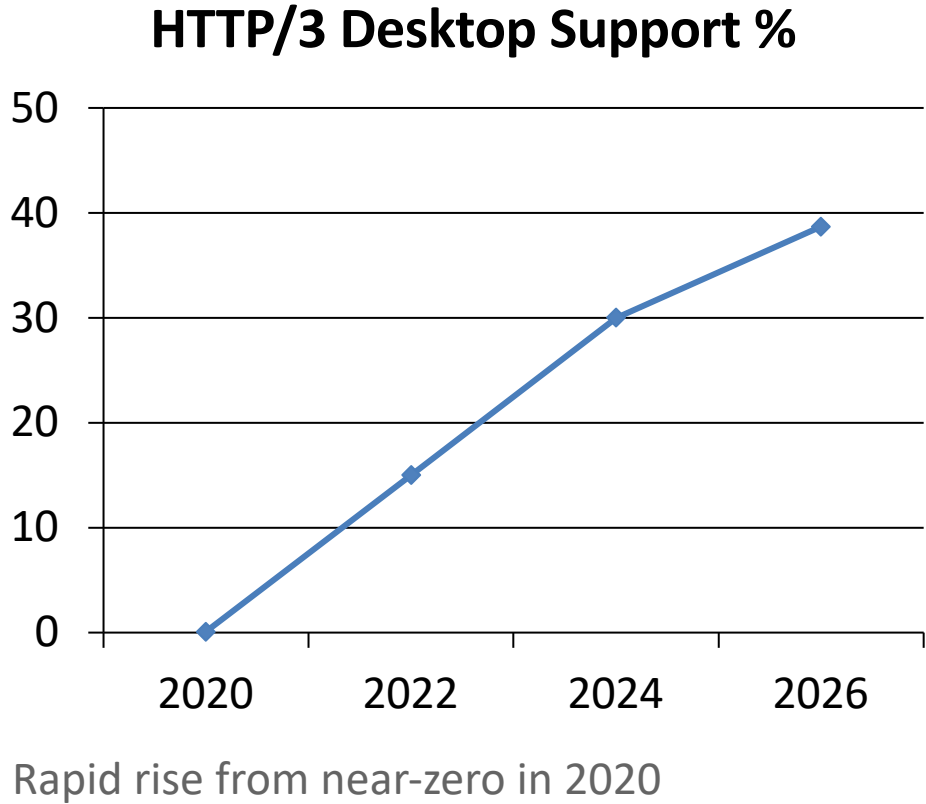
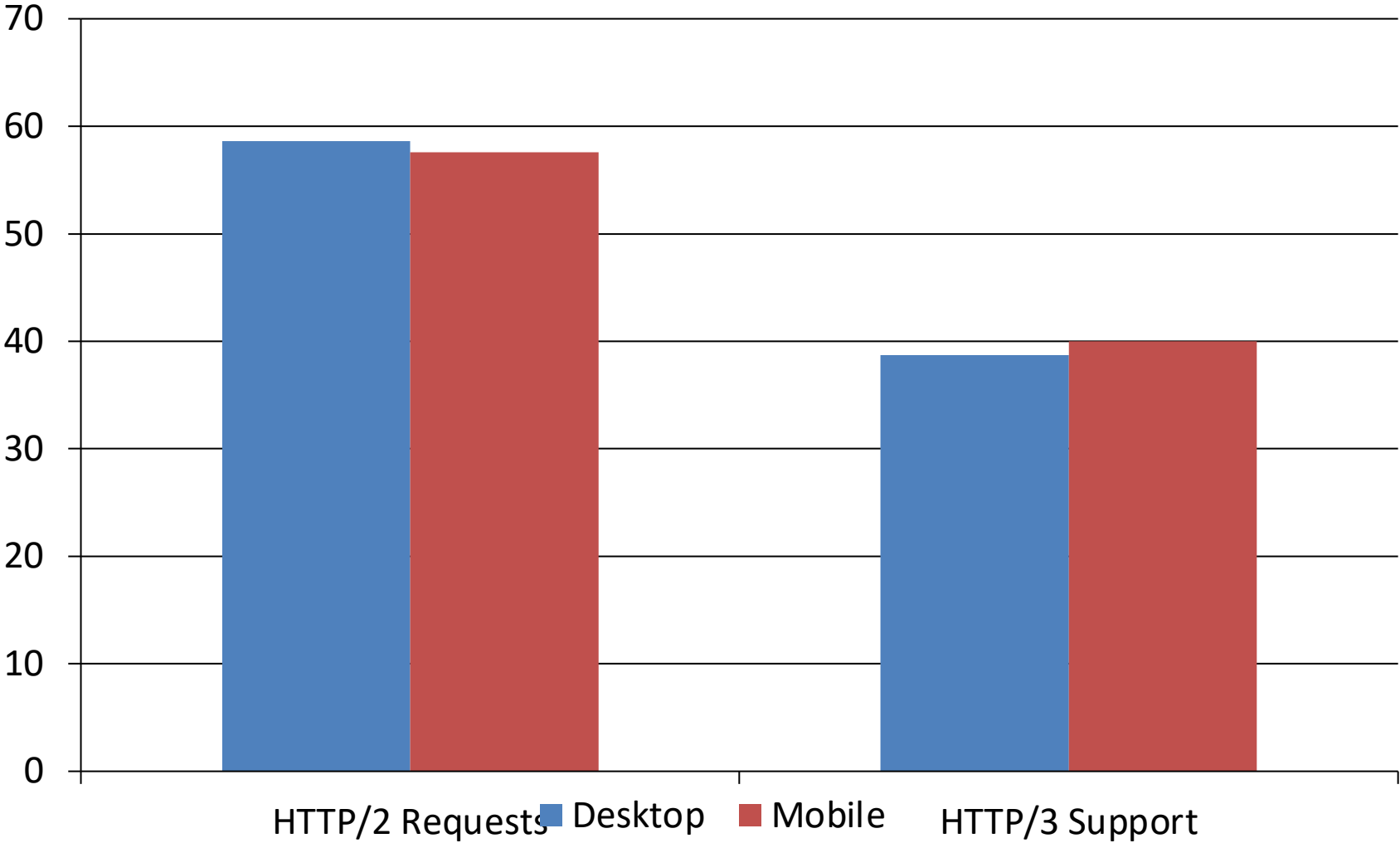
Desktop HTTPS Requests

99.1%

Mobile HTTPS Requests

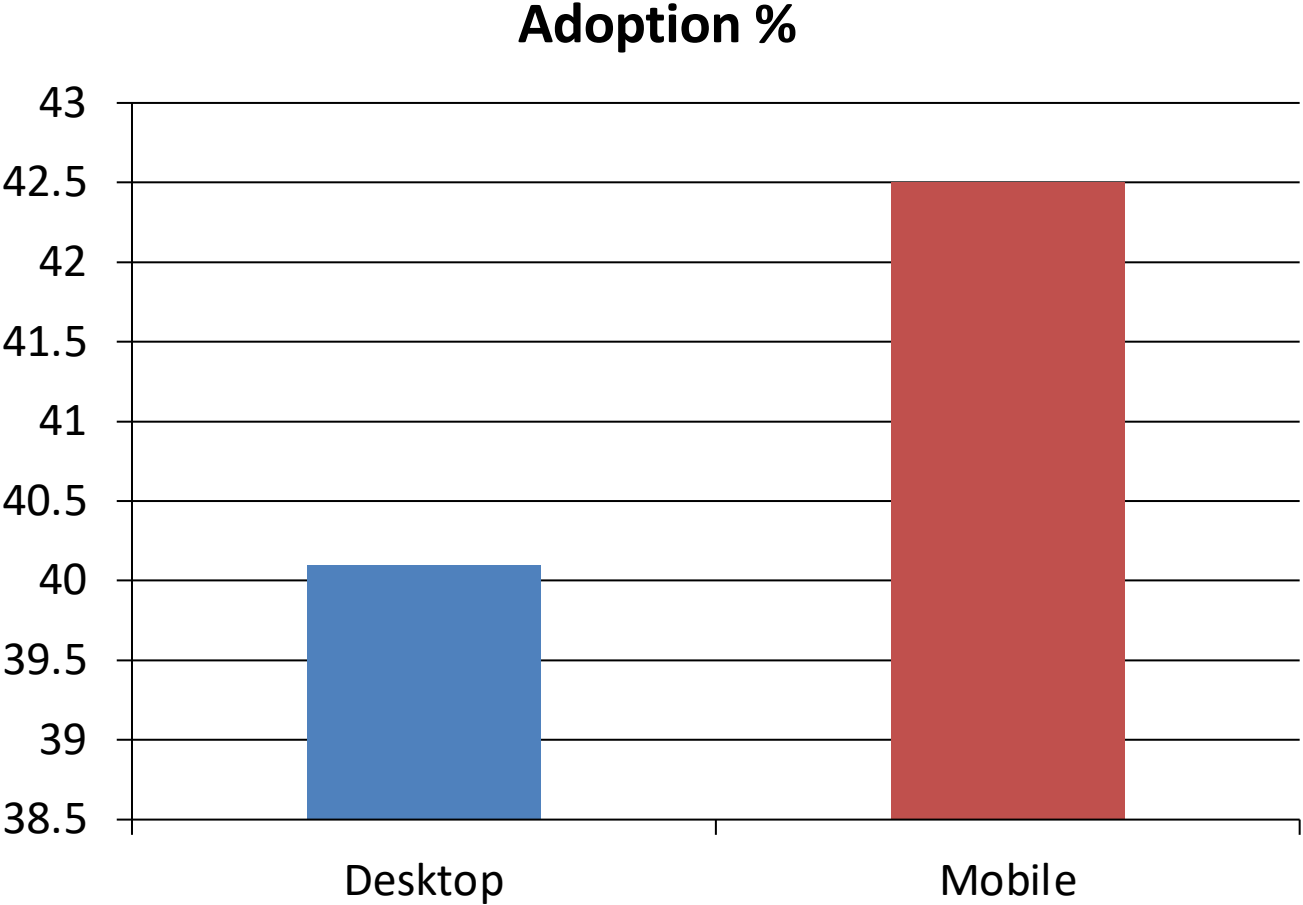


HTTP/2 Holds at ~58% While HTTP/3 Support Surges to 40%



*Note: HTTP Archive measures HTTP/3 support rather than usage because fresh Chrome instances default to HTTP/2 on first connection.

Font-Display Usage Reaches 42% on Mobile, Up 61% Since 2020



Why it matters:
The font-display CSS property helps avoid the Flash of Invisible Text (FOIT) during web font loading.

While adoption has grown significantly (desktop up 14.9%, mobile up 61.0% since 2020), more than half of pages still risk FOIT.

Key Takeaways: Bigger Pages, Smarter Protocols, Stronger Security

- **Page weight keeps climbing:** Median desktop pages now transfer ~2,000 KB, roughly 25% heavier than in 2020, driven by richer media and JavaScript.
- **HTTPS is the new baseline:** At 99%+ of requests, unencrypted HTTP is essentially extinct on the modern web.
- **HTTP/3 is the fastest-growing protocol metric:** From near-zero to ~40% support in under four years, HTTP/3 is rapidly becoming mainstream.
- **Fewer TCP connections despite more requests:** Multiplexing in HTTP/2 and HTTP/3 has cut median connections per page by 15–27%, improving network efficiency.
- **Font-display still underused:** At ~40–42% adoption, there is significant room for improvement in avoiding invisible text during font loading.
- **Action:** Benchmark your own sites against these baselines to prioritize optimization efforts.